Awarding body	**Arden University**
Programme Name	**B.Sc. Healthcare management**
Model name (and part if applicable)	**Global Health and Sustainability (HCM6001)**
Assessment tittle	**Academic poster**
Student Number	[redacted]
Tutor Name	[redacted]
Word count	**641 Words**

“National Plan to Address Alzheimer's Disease” In USA

Background/Setting of Context

Fact and Data

Over **six million Americans** have Alzheimer’s disease, with numbers expected to exceed 13 million by 2060. The disease progressively impairs brain function, causing cognitive decline, Behavioural Disorders, and reduced ability to perform daily activities (ASPE, 2022).

As illustrated in Figure 1, Alzheimer's disease has the highest mortality rate, making it a critical issue for discussion.

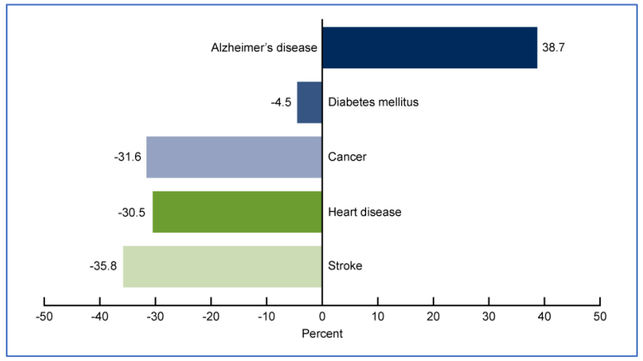


Figure 1: “Percent change in age-adjusted death rates, U.S., 2000–2010” (Tejada, 2013).

- **Global Impact**: Over **50 million people** worldwide have dementia.
- **Economic Burden**: Costs exceed **$1 trillion** per year.
- **Leading Cause of Death**: Dementia is the **5th leading cause of death** globally.
- **Disability Impact**: Alzheimer’s is the **4th leading cause of DALYs lost** in people **75+ years old**.

(Lanman et al., 2022)

Key Facts about Alzheimer’s Disease:

- Rates are **higher** in females.
- It is a **leading cause** of **death** in the US.
- **Education** may **lower** the risk of Alzheimer’s disease (Felman, 2024)

Figure 2 shows a projected rise in Alzheimer’s cases among older adults, increasing from **4.7 million in 2010** to **13.8 million by 2050**, with the sharpest growth in the **85+ age group**. This highlights the growing impact of Alzheimer’s disease in an ageing population, particularly among the oldest age groups (Bonneau, 2022).

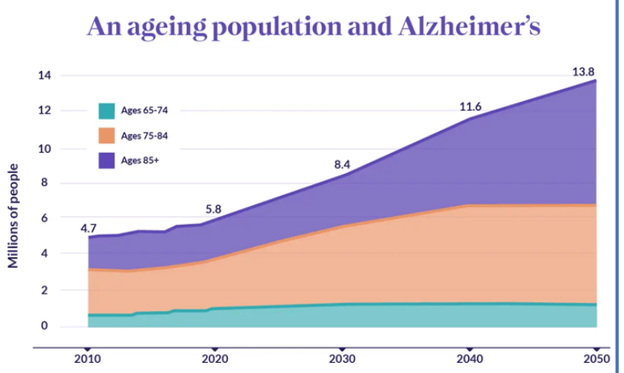


Figure 2 – An ageing population and Alzheimer’s (Bonneau, 2022).

Initiative Action Plan

The National Alzheimer's Project Act (NAPA), signed into law in 2011, aims to create a coordinated **national initiative** to combat Alzheimer’s disease and related dementias by advancing research, improving care, reducing disparities, and collaborating globally.

This **US initiative** has clear and reachable goals demonstrating the use of **SMART** goals.

Goals of the Initiative:

1. “Prevent and Effectively Treat Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias by 2025”
2. “Enhance Care Quality and Efficiency”
3. “Expand Supports for Individuals and their Caregivers”
4. “Enhance Public Awareness and Engagement”

According to Shevelkova et al. (2023), strategies under **SDG 3** predominantly address **Alzheimer’s** and dementia through early diagnosis and intervention.

- Alzheimer in **Europe** with “AD Detect Prevent”, “ADAIR” interventions (Alzheimer Europe, 2024).
- **Japan** also has digital technology initiatives to help tackle Alzheimer’s disease (Ota, 2024).

Effectiveness and Impact

After decades of extensive scientific research, the **FDA has approved multiple treatments** for early symptomatic Alzheimer’s disease.

- The NIH-supported PrecivityAD2 blood test **helps accurately diagnose AD** by measuring amyloid and tau (ASPE, 2024). This is supported by Meyer et al. (2024) as they state that in their experiment “The PrecivityAD2 blood test **showed strong clinical validity**”

Key Advances according to the National Plan’s intervention in Alzheimer’s Research (improved outcomes):

- **Genetic Discoveries:** From just 4 known genes 20 years ago, researchers have identified over 70 genetic areas linked to Alzheimer’s, opening new treatment possibilities.
- **Increased Clinical Trials:** More than 400 trials are now supported (compared to 38 in 2015), and efforts are being made to improve diversity in participation.
- **Prevention Strategies:** Research suggests that controlling blood pressure and adopting a healthy lifestyle may lower Alzheimer’s risk.

Impact: These advancements reduce diagnostic costs, increase clinical trial enrollment, and improve trial accessibility for diverse populations.

Challenges and Constraints of Implementation

- Current treatments are insufficient for all AD stages, requiring further research into diverse interventions.
- Dementia care quality and workforce training need improvement.
- Unpaid caregivers, mostly family members, require better support, with many experiencing depressions.

(ASPE, 2024).

Conclusion and Recommendations

In conclusion, while significant progress has been made in addressing the challenges of AD/ADRD through research, diagnostics, and improved care strategies, continued efforts are needed to expand access, support diverse populations, and develop effective treatments to better meet the needs of affected individuals and caregivers. A recommendation would be to **increase** access to **culturally** and **linguistically** appropriate long-term services and supports (LTSS) for **high-risk populations**, including rural and Tribal communities, individuals with limited English proficiency, and LGBTQ+ groups, especially those facing **social** and **economic challenges**.

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